

Fundamentals of Entrepreneurial Management I

Introduction

“Fundamentals of Entrepreneurial Management I” is an integrative capstone course in entrepreneurship. It is based on the insight that in today’s business environment entrepreneurial management skills are key for general managers and entrepreneurs alike. The course introduces cutting-edge material – theories, frameworks, perspectives – that allow you to acquire the basics of entrepreneurial management. At the same time, the course encourages you to adopt a holistic perspective on building new businesses, and it asks you to synthesize and apply what you have learned so far in the program.

Objectives

The course pursues two main objectives. First, it aims at teaching you how to critically assess business ideas in contexts varying from startup to corporate settings. Second, the course discusses the perspective of whether you “have what it takes” to be an entrepreneur. We do this by opening up the “black box” of entrepreneurship and by discussing the pros and cons of entrepreneurship as a career.

Content

Module 1 – Evaluating and conceptualizing the opportunity. The first sessions of the course explore the nature of business opportunities and the process of designing a business. The sessions in this module introduce a series of frameworks and tools to help critically assess ideas and design business models.

Module 2a – Resourcing the business. An entrepreneur’s fundamental challenge in implementing a new business is to identify, acquire, and manage necessary resources to “create something from nothing.” In the sessions in this module, we will discuss this key challenge as it relates to financing the early stages and assembling the team.

Module 2b – Scaling the business. Scaling a business that shows promise is another unique challenge for entrepreneurs. In this final module, we discuss the various hurdles in scaling and how to overcome them.

Evaluation

Grading type	Weight	Evaluation elements
Participation and contribution to class learning	50%	The most important part of your learning in this course will take place in the classroom. Participation and contribution to class learning will be determined by your ability to participate in the class discussion and provide unique, constructive insight about the topic at hand. Participation will be assessed both in terms of quality and quantity with greater weight on the quality and depth of your contributions.
Written exam	40%	The exam will be an open-book group exam to be taken on campus.
Individual reflection	10%	Submit a one-minute audio or video reflection on a class case of your choice by 9 pm the day before the class for that specific case.

Course Outline

Topic	Case / Activity
Module 1. Evaluating and conceptualizing the opportunity	
1. Intro & Evaluating Opportunities	Alhoia Capital
2. From Idea to Business Model	Aparkalo
3. Business Model Simulation I	Interactive session
4. Business Model Simulation II	Interactive session
5. Assembling a winning team	CarbonZen
Module 2. Resourcing and scaling the business	
6. Financing the Venture I	Interactive session
7. Financing the Venture II	Interactive session
8. Taking the leap	Nordic Mezzanine
9. Testing the business model	Flywire
10. Scaling the business	Farm Edge
Final Exam	

Detailed Course Outline

Session 1 – Evaluating Opportunities

Case: Alhoia Capital

Discussion Questions:

1. Which of these opportunities would you choose? Why?
2. What are the criteria that should be used to evaluate business opportunities? Why?

Session 2 – From Idea to Business Model

Case: Aparkalo (A)

Discussion Questions:

1. Is it a good idea?
2. Evaluate Ivan and Luis's efforts to date. Have they done their homework? What else could they do?

Sessions 3 & 4: No case

Session 5 – Assembling a Winning Team

Case: Carbon Zen

Discussion Questions:

1. Is the equity distribution fair? Why or why not?
2. How efficiently are they deploying their labor?

Sessions 6 & 7: No case

Session 8 – Taking the Leap

Case: Nordic Mezzanine

Discussion Questions:

1. What is the downside for Harry to take the leap?
2. What factors beyond the business itself should you consider when becoming an entrepreneur?

Session 9 – Testing the Business Model

Case: Flywire

Discussion questions:

1. What do you consider the main strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats for Flywire's business model?
2. How would you model the unit economics?

Session 10 – Scaling the Business

Case: Farm Edge

Discussion Questions:

1. What is the trade-off David is facing?
2. Which side would you choose? Why?

Instructor

Prof. Liinus
Hietaniemi



Prof. Hietaniemi specializes in the areas of entrepreneurship and strategic human capital. He applies mathematical modelling and quantitative empirical research methods to study how founder and startup employee characteristics affect startup growth and individual-level returns to entrepreneurship. He has published on these topics in *Strategic Management Journal*, which is one of the top-tier academic journals in the field. His research has also been featured in leading media outlets such as *Forbes*.

Prof. Hietaniemi holds PhD and Master of Research degrees from London Business School, a Master of Science degree from Imperial College London, and a Bachelor of Arts degree from Harvard University. Prior to his academic career, Liinus designed and developed algorithms as a startup cofounder and early employee in the software industry. In his free time, he develops new software, trains Brazilian jiu jitsu and spends time with his wife and three kids.

Areas of Interest

- * Startup scaling
- * Returns to entrepreneurship
- * Startups as a career choice
- * Opportunity cost of entrepreneurship
- * Technological innovation

Additional Information for Reporting and Accreditation purposes

Learning Outcomes

1. Critically evaluate relevant information for better decision-making.
2. Apply negotiation techniques effectively in any environment, ensuring stability and fairness for all parties involved.
3. Integrate economic efficiency, ethical criteria respecting human dignity, and sustainability of the planet into decision-making.
4. Apply necessary tools to prevent and detect fraudulent or unethical behaviors, developing an ethical sense in decision-making.
5. Create rigorous, viable, and sustainable business plans for potential investors.
6. Build innovation processes with an impact on the organization and the market.
7. Develop techniques for effective communication.
8. Analyze the impact of business decisions from the perspective of general management operating in a globally competitive context.
9. Apply entrepreneurial behavior with a creative and open mindset, driving necessary changes with energy and personal responsibility.
10. Develop trust and foster employee identification with the company's mission.
11. Evaluate the impact of the global macroeconomic and microeconomic environments on specific business activities to develop action plans and adapt to uncertain environments.

Sustainable Development Goals (SDG)

- SDG 1 – No Poverty
- SDG 2 – Zero Hunger
- SDG 3 – Good Health and Well-Being
- SDG 4 – Quality Education
- SDG 5 – Gender Equality
- SDG 6 – Clean Water and Sanitation
- SDG 7 – Affordable and Clean Energy
- SDG 8 – Decent Work and Economic Growth
- SDG 9 – Industry Innovation and Infrastructure
- SDG 10 – Reduced Inequalities
- SDG 11 – Sustainable Cities and Communities
- SDG 12 – Responsible Consumption and Production
- SDG 13 – Climate Action
- SDG 14 – Life Below Water
- SDG 15 – Life on Land
- SDG 16 – Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions
- SDG 17 – Partnerships for the Goals